

Work, Pressure and Promises Online

Recognising trafficking and exploitation



BIG IDEA Some people use tricks, pressure and control to make others work for their benefit. Online it can start with an offer that is too good or a “friend” who asks for secrecy. Spot the flags, say no, and tell. It is never your fault.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

REVIEW STATUS REQUIRES REVIEW BY A TRAFFICKING-PREVENTION SPECIALIST BEFORE CLASSROOM USE. Written 2026-10-05, not yet reviewed by anyone outside the author.

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN Specialist and counselor review done. Pre-notice and opt-out slip out 5 school days ahead; opt-outs do “Job Scams” (RP1-ALT) with a supervising adult. Teach mid-week, after Lessons 1 and 6.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: RP1 Offer Cards (six per group), Flag Strips, Control Signs card, Reporting Quick Card, Pass cards.

- ☐ Reporting Quick Card (RP1) in hand, with your state’s routes.
- ☐ Opt-out space ready. Show no real image, ad or profile; ask for no personal story.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hackles up? When an offer online feels too good, or someone says “keep this between us,” trust that feeling. “Dani is a made-up kid, nobody shares anything personal, and your Pass card works at any time. Human trafficking is when someone uses tricks, pressure or threats to control another person and make them work, or be used, for someone else’s gain. It is a crime. We focus on early warning signs, because early is when you can still walk away and telling helps most.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Offer Check

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-P1.** Dani, thirteen, gets a “talent scout” message: “You could make real money. Don’t tell anyone yet. We just need to chat on a different app.” Dani feels flattered and uneasy. Listen to the uneasy feeling.
- 2 (5 min) Offer Check.** Groups sort six made-up Offer Cards GREEN, YELLOW or RED and circle flags: **SECRET, TOO GOOD, MOVE** (to another app, or alone), **OWE** (a favor that becomes a debt), **CUT OFF** (from family or friends), **TAKES** (money, phone, documents). Two cards are fine. Ask: who is this, what do they want, who else knows? The Control Signs card describes a person being controlled and never something they did wrong.
- 3 (2 min) Triads** (Speaker, Listener, Observer; nobody plays the scout): “I need your help with something online. A friend was offered money by someone they do not know and told not to tell anyone. Can you help me figure out what to do?” Then read the Reporting Quick Card.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why might someone ignore the uneasy feeling?”
- 2** “Why is ‘keep it a secret’ a flag? What is a safe secret?” (A surprise party versus a secret that gets someone hurt.)
- 3** “What if someone already said yes?” (Still tell. It is not your fault.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause before you answer an offer that is secret, too good, or pushing you to move. Check it with someone. Tell a trusted adult. It is never your fault, and never too late.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: “A real offer can stand being talked about.”

EXIT TICKET “Write one flag from today and one adult you could tell.”

FUN BOOST Silent Gallery (calm; no scoring).

Groups walk silently to another table to see where groups agreed or differed.

LEVEL-UP Helper Poster. With counselor approval, a school poster with the six flags and hotline numbers, with no pictures of people.

DIFFERENTIATE Three Offer Cards, a Tell-3 sentence frame, a buddy.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “If someone online offered you something and said not to tell anyone, who would you tell?” Hotlines: 1-855-FLA-SAFE; 1-800-962-2873; danger: 911.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault. The people who use tricks are responsible.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Why did you go along with it?” or “Are you sure?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- Contacting the person or the family.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: report immediately (Florida Abuse or Human Trafficking Hotline per district procedure); tell your counselor or designated person; follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law. Tell the family only when the agency or an administrator advises.